05 Parteien und Koalitionen

Parties and coalitions · Lesson and all exam questions

10 questions · about 1.0 of your 33 exam questions come from this topic · 7 to memorize, 3 common sense

> Germany is almost always governed by coalitions, and they get nicknames from the party colours, like the 'Ampel' (traffic light).

In 60 seconds

- **CDU**, **CSU**, **SPD**, **FDP**: know what the letters stand for.
- Parties working together to form a government = **Koalition**.
- The two biggest groups in today's Bundestag: **CDU/CSU and AfD**.
- A party that fights the constitution can be banned.

The abbreviations

- **CDU** = Christlich Demokratische Union. **CSU** = Christlich Soziale Union, the CDU's sister party that only runs in Bayern. Q76 Q92
- **SPD** = Sozialdemokratische Partei Deutschlands. **FDP** = Freie Demokratische Partei. Q78 Q79

Today's Bundestag

- The two largest parliamentary groups (Fraktionen) are currently **CDU/CSU and AfD** (since the February 2025 election). Q73

Coalitions

- Parties working together to form a government = **Koalition**. Q31
- **Ampelkoalition** (traffic light) = **SPD** (red), **FDP** (yellow) and **Bündnis 90/Die Grünen** (green). Q103
- Why more than one party? So that **the different opinions of citizens are represented**. common sense Q41

Banned parties

- A party aiming for a dictatorship is **verfassungswidrig** (unconstitutional). A party can be banned **when it fights against the constitution**, not for criticising the government. common sense Q20 Q43

All 10 exam questions of this topic

Frage 76 · memorize

Was bedeutet die Abkürzung CDU in Deutschland?

What does the abbreviation CDU stand for in Germany?

✓ **Christlich Demokratische Union** (Christian Democratic Union)

Frage 92 · memorize

Was bedeutet die Abkürzung CSU in Deutschland?

What does the abbreviation CSU stand for in Germany?

✓ **Christlich Soziale Union** (Christian Social Union)

Frage 78 · memorize

Was bedeutet die Abkürzung SPD?

What does the abbreviation SPD stand for?

✓ **Sozialdemokratische Partei Deutschlands** (Social Democratic Party of Germany)

Frage 79 · memorize

Was bedeutet die Abkürzung FDP in Deutschland?

What does the abbreviation FDP stand for in Germany?

✓ **Freie Demokratische Partei** (Free Democratic Party)

Frage 73 · memorize

Die beiden größten Fraktionen im Deutschen Bundestag heißen zurzeit ...

The two largest parliamentary groups in the German Bundestag are currently called ...

✓ **CDU/CSU und AfD.** (CDU/CSU and AfD.)

Frage 31 · memorize

Die Zusammenarbeit von Parteien zur Bildung einer Regierung nennt man in Deutschland ...

In Germany, the cooperation of parties to form a government is called a ...

✓ **Koalition.** (Coalition.)

Frage 103 · memorize

Was wird in Deutschland als "Ampelkoalition" bezeichnet? Die Zusammenarbeit ...

What is called the "traffic light coalition" in Germany? The cooperation ...

✓ **von SPD, FDP und Bündnis 90/Die Grünen in einer Regierung** (of SPD, FDP, and Bündnis 90/Die Grünen in one government)

Frage 41 · common sense

Warum gibt es in einer Demokratie mehr als eine Partei?

Why are there more than one party in a democracy?

✓ **weil dadurch die unterschiedlichen Meinungen der Bürgerinnen und Bürger vertreten werden** (because this allows the diverse opinions of citizens to be represented)

Frage 20 · common sense

Eine Partei in Deutschland verfolgt das Ziel, eine Diktatur zu errichten. Sie ist dann …

A political party in Germany pursues the goal of establishing a dictatorship. It is then …

✓ **verfassungswidrig.** (unconstitutional.)

Frage 43 · common sense

Wann kann in Deutschland eine Partei verboten werden?

When can a political party be banned in Germany?

✓ **wenn sie gegen die Verfassung kämpft** (if it fights against the constitution)

Study files for the Einbürgerungstest (Bayern). Answers from the official BAMF catalog. The lesson and translations are study aids, not official texts.